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Geography

People: India (People and Economy)

India: People and Economy: Population Distribution, Density, Growth Epochs, Composition, Migration & Occupational Matrix

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Module 1: Population Distribution & Spatial Density

1.1 Spatial Patterns of Population Distribution in India

India is the world's most populous nation, housing over 1.21 billion people according to the 2011 Census of India (constituting approximately 17.5% of the global population on barely 2.4% of the world's total terrestrial land area). The spatial distribution of population across India is profoundly uneven, exhibiting stark geographical contrasts:

- **Densely Populated Core:** Uttar Pradesh is the most populous state (19.98 crore, 16.5% of India's aggregate population), followed by Maharashtra (11.23 crore), Bihar (10.40 crore), West Bengal (9.12 crore), and Andhra Pradesh (including undivided Telangana, 8.45 crore). These five premier states together account for nearly half (48.9%) of India's aggregate populace.
- **Sparsely Populated Periphery:** States with vast geographical expanse but small, sparse populations include Jammu & Kashmir (1.04%), Arunachal Pradesh (0.11%), and Uttarakhand (0.84%). Sikkim is the least populous state (6.10 lakh), while Lakshadweep is the least populous Union Territory (64,473 persons).

MULTI-FACTOR DETERMINANTS OF POPULATION DISTRIBUTION

The spatial distribution of India's populace is governed by a complex interplay of physical, historical, and socio-economic variables:

- **Physical Physiographic Factors:** Relief, climate, water availability, and soil fertility represent the fundamental primary determinants. The flat, deep alluvial plains of the Northern River Basins (Ganga, Brahmaputra, Yamuna) and the fertile coastal deltas (Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri) have supported continuous sedentary agriculture for millennia. In sharp contrast, rugged montane relief (Himalayas), hyper-arid sandy deserts (Western Rajasthan), and dissected plateaus with dense forest cover (central tribal tracts) enforce low carrying capacities.
- **Climatic Thresholds:** Areas receiving over 100 cm of annual rainfall (Ganga Plain, Kerala coastal plains) support dense human settlement, whereas zones receiving less than 50 cm of precipitation (Western Thar Desert) support only sparse nomadic pastoralist populations.
- **Socio-Economic & Historical Factors:** Evolution of settled agriculture, historic irrigation networks (e.g., canal colonization in Punjab, Haryana, and the Indira Gandhi Canal command area in Rajasthan), mineral extraction (Chotanagpur coal and iron ore belt), industrial agglomerations (Mumbai-Pune, Ahmedabad-Vadodara, Hooghly corridor), and high-density transport spines stimulate massive population clustering.

1.2 Density of Population: Concepts and Spatial Typologies

Population density is defined as the number of persons inhabiting per unit area of land. It serves as a vital empirical index for evaluating the human-land ratio and territorial carrying capacity. According to Census 2011, India's overall arithmetic population density stands at **382 persons per square kilometer** (up from 325 in 2001, and 117 in 1951).

THREE CRUCIAL MEASURES OF LAND-MAN RATIO

Standard arithmetic density fails to account for agricultural land stress in predominantly agrarian economies. Hence, geographers employ physiological and agricultural density indices:

$$\text{Arithmetic Density} = \frac{\text{Total Population}}{\text{Total Geographical Area}}$$

$$\text{Physiological Density} = \frac{\text{Total Population}}{\text{Net Cultivated (Sown) Area}}$$

$$\text{Agricultural Density} = \frac{\text{Total Agricultural Population}}{\text{Net Cultivated (Sown) Area}}$$

- **Agricultural Population** strictly includes cultivators, agricultural labourers, and their dependent family members.
- In states like Kerala and Bihar, where net cultivated land is severely restricted, physiological density exceeds 1,500 to 2,000 persons per square kilometer of cultivated land.



Figure 1: India's Historic Population Growth Epochs and Spatial Density Classification Matrix

Spatial Density Classification of Indian States (Census 2011)

Density Category	Density Range	Representative States / Union Territories & Key Dynamics
Very High Density	Above 1,000 persons/km²	**Bihar (1,106)** — highest among all states; **West Bengal (1,028)**; NCT of Delhi (11,320 — highest among all UTs); Chandigarh (9,258).
High Density	501 – 1,000 persons/km²	**Uttar Pradesh (829)**, **Kerala (860)**, Tamil Nadu (555), Punjab (551), Haryana (573). Characterized by rich alluvial plains or coastal fertile belts.

Density Category	Density Range	Representative States / Union Territories & Key Dynamics
Moderate Density	251 – 500 persons/km^2	Assam (398), Jharkhand (414), Gujarat (308), Andhra Pradesh (308), Karnataka (319), Odisha (270), Maharashtra (365), Goa (394).
Low Density	101 – 250 persons/km^2	Madhya Pradesh (236), Rajasthan (200), Chhattisgarh (189), Meghalaya (132), Himachal Pradesh (123), Manipur (128), Nagaland (119).
Very Low Density	Below 100 persons/km^2	**Arunachal Pradesh (17)** — lowest among all states; **Mizoram (52)**; **Sikkim (86)**; Andaman & Nicobar Islands (46). Harsh relief and dense forest cover.

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Module 2: Population Growth: Four Historic Epochs

2.1 The Concept and Components of Population Growth

Population growth represents the change in the number of inhabitants inhabiting a territory over a specific period of time. This change may be positive (increase) or negative (decrease), and is expressed either in absolute numerical figures or as a decadal percentage:

- **Components of Population Growth:**
  1. **Natural Growth:** Evaluated exclusively by the crude birth rate (CBR) minus crude death rate (CDR):

$$\text{Natural Increase} = \text{Crude Birth Rate (CBR)} - \text{Crude Death Rate (CDR)}$$

  2. **Induced Growth:** Evaluated by net spatial mobility (migratory flows across territorial boundaries):

$$\text{Induced Increase} = \text{Gross In-migration} - \text{Gross Out-migration}$$

- The decadal growth rate of India's population between 2001 and 2011 was **17.64%**, down significantly from **21.54%** recorded during 1991–2001, indicating a clear transition toward demographic stabilization.

2.2 The Four Distinct Phases of Demographic Evolution (1901–2011+)

Demographers divide the modern trajectory of India's population growth over the last century (1901–2011+) into four clear, distinctive demographic phases:

Phase I (1901 – 1921): The Period of Stagnant / Dormant Growth

- **Characteristics:** Characterized by extremely high birth rates (48 per 1,000) counterbalanced by equally catastrophic death rates (47 per 1,000), resulting in a stationary or stagnant demographic profile.

- **Negative Growth Anomaly:** The decade **1911–1921** recorded an unprecedented **negative growth rate of −0.31%** (an absolute population loss of 7.7 lakh people), caused by the devastating global Influenza Pandemic of 1918 (Spanish Flu), widespread crop failures, and recurrent bubonic plague and cholera epidemics.
- **The Great Divide:** The year **1921** is universally designated by Indian demographers as the **"Year of the Great Divide"**, because mortality never exceeded fertility thereafter, and India transitioned out of demographic stagnation.

Phase II (1921 – 1951): The Period of Steady Growth

- **Characteristics:** Sustained, steady population growth averaging 1.0% to 1.3% annually.
- **Mortality Transition:** Significant expansion of public health infrastructure, basic sanitation, and the introduction of sulfur drugs and rudimentary inoculation curbed mortality from epidemics. Improved railway networks enabled prompt famine-relief food shipments, reducing starvation.
- **Fertility Profile:** Crude birth rates remained stubbornly high, widening the natural increase gap.

Phase III (1951 – 1981): The Period of Population Explosion

- **Characteristics:** Explosive demographic surge resulting in more than doubling of India's population from 36.1 crore in 1951 to 68.3 crore in 1981.
- **Medical Revolution:** Introduction of modern antibiotics (penicillin), mass vaccination campaigns, DDT spraying against malaria, and centralized Five-Year developmental planning drastically crushed the crude death rate.
- **Peak Growth Rate:** The decadal growth rate soared to its historical pinnacle of **24.80%** during **1961–1971**, averaging over 2.2% annual growth.
- **Induced Growth Contribution:** High natural increase was augmented by international refugee inflows from Tibet, East Pakistan (Bangladesh liberation war, 1971), Nepal, and Pakistan.

Phase IV (1981 – 2011+): High Growth with Definite Slowing Down

- **Characteristics:** India's population continued to increase in absolute numbers, but the rate of growth exhibited a clear, continuous deceleration.
- **Fertility Deceleration:** The crude birth rate dropped from 37.2 in 1971–81 to 21.8 per 1,000 by 2011. This was catalyzed by rising female literacy, urbanization, postponement of marriage age, and widespread adoption of family welfare techniques.
- **Decadal Slowdown:** Growth slipped from 23.87% (1981–91) to 21.54% (1991–2001), and down to **17.64%** during **2001–2011**.

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Module 3: Regional Disparities & National Population Policies

3.1 Regional Variations in Population Growth

A prominent spatial dimension of India's demographic transition is the pronounced regional divergence in growth trajectories between northern and southern states:

- **Southern Low-Growth Belt:** Kerala (4.9% — lowest decadal growth among all major states), Tamil Nadu (15.6%), Andhra Pradesh (11.0%), Karnataka (15.6%), and Goa (8.2%) have all attained below-replacement fertility rates (TFR < 2.1). Kerala's pioneering

demographic transition is attributed to near-universal female literacy, delayed age at marriage, and high-density rural primary health centers.

- **Northern & Central High-Growth Belt (EAG States):** The Empowered Action Group (EAG) states maintain high natural growth rates: Bihar (25.4%), Uttar Pradesh (20.2%), Rajasthan (21.3%), Madhya Pradesh (20.3%), and Jharkhand (22.4%). These states possess high total fertility rates (TFR), widespread rural poverty, and lower female literacy.

ADOLESCENT DEMOGRAPHICS & THE DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

- **Adolescent Population Share:** According to Census 2011, adolescents (defined as individuals in the **10–19 age group**) constitute **20.9%** of India's total population (comprising 25.3 crore persons; 52.7% male and 47.3% female).
- **Socio-Demographic Vulnerabilities:** High incidence of early marriage, female school dropout rates, adolescent pregnancy, high maternal mortality, and widespread iron-deficiency anemia among adolescent girls (exceeding 56%).
- **Demographic Dividend:** The colossal youth cohort represents a powerful economic window of opportunity, provided high-quality education, healthcare, and employment skills are developed.

3.2 National Population Policy (NPP 2000) & National Youth Policy (NYP 2014)

To address demographic imperatives, the Government of India promulgated comprehensive national policies:

Strategic Framework: NPP 2000 vs. NYP 2014

Policy Document	Target Focus & Definition	Cardinal Objectives & Exam High-Yield Mandates
National Population Policy (NPP 2000)	Holistic health, fertility, and reproductive welfare framework	1. Universal free & compulsory school education up to age 14. 2. Reduce Infant Mortality Rate (IMR) to below 30 per 1,000 live births. 3. Reduce Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR) to below 100 per 100,000. 4. Universal immunization of children against vaccine-preventable diseases. 5. Promote delayed marriage for girls (strictly above 18, preferably after 20). 6. Achieve population stabilization by the target year 2045.

Policy Document	Target Focus & Definition	Cardinal Objectives & Exam High-Yield Mandates
National Youth Policy (NYP 2014)	Holistic development of youth (**defined as 15–29 years**)	1. Develop productive workforce through education, entrepreneurship, and skill development. 2. Foster health, healthy lifestyles, and sports engagement. 3. Inculcate civic values and community volunteering. 4. Youth empowerment: digital literacy and inclusion of marginalized youth.

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Module 4: Population Composition: Linguistic, Religious & Ethnic

4.1 Linguistic Composition of India

India is a veritable linguistic mosaic. Sir George Grierson's historic **Linguistic Survey of India (1903–1928)** identified 179 distinct languages and 544 regional dialects. In modern India, the Constitution recognizes **22 Scheduled Languages** under the Eighth Schedule.



Figure 2: Comprehensive Population Composition Framework: Linguistic, Religious, Rural-Urban, and Occupational Matrix

Classification of Language Families in India (Grierson Classification)

Language Family	Sub-Family / Branch	% of Speakers	Major Languages & Spatial Geographical Distribution
Indo-European (Aryan)	Indo-Aryan Branch	**73.0%** (Largest)	Hindi, Bengali, Marathi, Urdu, Gujarati, Punjabi, Odia, Assamese, Maithili, Kashmiri, Sanskrit. Northern, Central, and Western plains.
Dravidian (Dravida)	South, Central, & North Dravidian	**20.0%** (2nd Largest)	Telugu (largest Dravidian speaker base), Tamil, Kannada, Malayalam; tribal tongues: Gondi, Kurukh/Oraon. Peninsular India.
Austroasiatic (Nishada)	Munda & Mon-Khmer Branches	**1.38%**	Santhali, Mundari, Ho, Birhor, Kharia (Central Chotanagpur plateau); Khasi and Jaintia (Meghalaya, Mon-Khmer branch).
Sino-Tibetan (Kirata)	Tibeto-Myanmarese & North Assam	**0.85%** (Smallest)	Bodo, Naga, Manipuri/Meitei, Lushei/Mizo, Garo, Dafla, Mishing, Bhotia, Kinnauri, Ladakhi. Himalayan & Northeast borderlands.

4.2 Religious Composition of India

Religion exerts a decisive influence on the cultural, social, and political geography of India:

Demographic and Spatial Profile of Religious Communities (Census 2011)

Religion	Population	% of Total	Spatial Geographic Concentration & Salient Demographics
Hindus	96.63 Crore	**79.8%**	Majoritarian across most states (exceeds 80–90% in Himachal Pradesh, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh). Less than 50% in J&K, Punjab, and NE.
Muslims	17.22 Crore	**14.2%**	Largest religious minority. Form demographic majorities in **Jammu & Kashmir** (68.3%) and **Lakshadweep** (96.5%). High clustering in WB, UP, Bihar, Kerala.
Christians	2.78 Crore	**2.3%**	Concentrated in the North-Eastern tribal states (**Nagaland 88%, Mizoram 87%, Meghalaya 75%**),

Religion	Population	% of Total	Spatial Geographic Concentration & Salient Demographics
			Goa (25%), and coastal Kerala (18%).
Sikhs	2.08 Crore	**1.7%**	Heavily concentrated in their historic homeland of **Punjab** (57.7% of state populace), adjoining districts of Haryana, and Delhi.
Buddhists	0.84 Crore	**0.7%**	Concentrated in **Maharashtra** (largest absolute number, Neo-Buddhist movement of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar), Ladakh, Sikkim, and Arunachal Pradesh.
Jains	0.45 Crore	**0.4%**	Highly urbanized commercial community; concentrated in urban centers of Rajasthan, Gujarat, Maharashtra (Mumbai), and Madhya Pradesh.

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Module 5: Rural-Urban Dynamics & Migration Patterns

5.1 Rural-Urban Composition

According to Census 2011, India's population is divided between rural and urban settlements as follows:

- **Rural Population: 68.8%** (83.3 crore people) living across 6,40,867 inhabited villages.
  - **Inter-State Disparities: Himachal Pradesh** is the most rural state (89.97% rural), followed by **Bihar** (88.71%), Assam (85.90%), and Odisha (83.31%).
  - Agriculture, livestock rearing, and rural cottage crafts form the primary livelihood foundations.
- **Urban Population: 31.2%** (37.7 crore people) inhabiting statutory and census towns.
  - **Inter-State Disparities:** Among major states, **Goa** has the highest level of urbanization (62.17% urban), followed by **Mizoram** (52.11%), Tamil Nadu (48.40%), Kerala (47.70%), and Maharashtra (45.22%).
  - Among Union Territories, **NCT of Delhi** is 97.5% urban, and **Chandigarh** is 97.25% urban.

CENSUS CRITERIA FOR DEFINING AN 'URBAN AREA' IN INDIA

The Census of India classifies urban areas into two distinct statutory categories:

1. **Statutory Towns:** All places with a municipality, municipal corporation, cantonment board, or notified town area committee established by law.

2. **Census Towns:** Places that satisfy all three of the following empirical demographic criteria:
   - A minimum population of **5,000 persons**.
   - At least **75% of the male main working population** engaged in non-agricultural pursuits.
   - A minimum population density of **400 persons per square kilometer**.

5.2 Internal Migration Streams & Push-Pull Mechanics

Migration represents a decisive factor altering the spatial redistribution of population across states:

- **Four Internal Migration Streams:**
  1. **Rural-to-Rural (R-R):** The most voluminous migration stream in India; heavily dominated by females due to the pan-Indian cultural institution of **marriage migration** (virilocal exogamy).
  2. **Rural-to-Urban (R-U):** Highly significant for economic urbanization; predominantly male-dominated, driven by employment, higher education, and livelihood security.
  3. **Urban-to-Urban (U-U):** Step-wise migration up the urban hierarchy from smaller towns to metropolitan centers.
  4. **Urban-to-Rural (U-R):** Minor stream, often associated with retirement return-migration.
- **Push vs. Pull Dynamics:**
  - **Push Factors (Rural Outflow):** Deep-rooted rural poverty, severe land fragmentation, seasonal and disguised unemployment, inadequate educational and healthcare infrastructure, and recurring environmental disasters (droughts in Bundelkhand, annual floods in North Bihar and Assam).
  - **Pull Factors (Urban Inflow):** Assured wages in industrial and informal services, access to modern healthcare, quality higher education, cosmopolitan culture, and infrastructural security.
- **Leading Migration Corridors:** Uttar Pradesh and Bihar represent the largest net out-migrating states; Maharashtra, NCT of Delhi, Gujarat, and Haryana are the premier destination hubs. Greater Mumbai attracted the largest absolute volume of interstate migrants, followed by Delhi.

5.3 Socio-Economic and Environmental Consequences of Migration

Internal migration generates profound spatial, demographic, and economic ramifications across both sending and receiving regions:

- **Economic Consequences:**
  - **Remittances:** Financial remittances sent by migrants to rural home villages constitute the financial lifeline of rural households ("Money Order Economy"). In states like Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha, and Himachal Pradesh, remittances fund agricultural inputs, debt repayment, healthcare, and education.
  - **International Remittances:** Migration from states like Punjab, Kerala, and Gujarat to the Gulf and Western nations generates enormous foreign exchange reserves (India receives over $100 billion annually).

- **Demographic Consequences:**
  - **Skewed Age-Sex Structure:** Selective male-dominated out-migration from rural tracts strips villages of their economically productive male workforce, leading to high dependency ratios and distorted rural sex ratios.
  - **Metropolitan Masculinization:** Receiving urban industrial centers (e.g., Surat, Mumbai, Ludhiana) display highly male-skewed sex ratios in the working-age cohort.
- **Social Consequences:**
  - **Feminization of Agriculture:** With working-age men migrating to urban industrial hubs, rural agricultural operations are increasingly managed and executed by women, who function as primary farm managers without possessing legal land tenure.
  - **Diffusion of Innovations:** Returning migrants diffuse modern agricultural techniques, family planning awareness, female literacy values, and entrepreneurial concepts to conservative rural societies.
- **Environmental Consequences:**
  - Colossal rural-to-urban influx overburdens existing urban physical infrastructure, leading to the proliferation of squatter settlements and unplanned slums (e.g., **Dharavi** in Mumbai), acute drinking water deficits, traffic congestion, and solid waste crises.

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Module 6: Occupational Structure & High-Yield Synthesis Mindmap

6.1 Occupational Matrix and Economic Status

The occupational structure of a nation reflects the proportion of its working population engaged in various economic sectors:

- **Census Economic Classification of Workers (Criterion: 183 Days):**
  - **Main Workers:** Persons who work in economically productive activity for **at least 183 days** (or six months) in the year preceding enumeration. They constitute **77.8%** of India's total working populace.
  - **Marginal Workers:** Persons who work for **less than 183 days** (six months) during the year. They constitute **22.2%** of total workers, reflecting significant underemployment.
  - **Non-Workers:** Dependent persons who do not participate in any economically productive activity (students, homemakers, infants, elderly retirees), comprising **60.2%** of India's aggregate populace.
  - **Work Participation Rate:** The percentage of total workers (Main + Marginal) to the total population:

$$\text{Work Participation Rate} = \frac{\text{Total Workers (Main + Marginal)}}{\text{Total Population}} \times 100 = 39.8\%$$

Four Standard Occupational Categories of Workers (Census 2011)

Occupational Category	% of Workers	Syllabus Characteristics & Sectoral Dynamics
1. Cultivators	**24.6%**	Farmers who operate their own or leased land; proportion declining due to land subdivision and farm mechanization.
2. Agricultural Labourers	**30.0%**	Landless farm workers employed on others' land for daily cash/crop wages; highly vulnerable to seasonal unemployment.
3. Household Industry Workers	**3.8%**	Artisans engaged in cottage manufacturing, handloom weaving, rural carpentry, and pottery.
4. Other Workers	**41.6%**	Workers engaged in secondary and tertiary activities: manufacturing, trade, transport, IT, banking, education, and administration.

6.2 Sectoral Shift, Regional Work Participation & Gender Dynamics

- **Historical Sectoral Transition:** In 1951, the primary agricultural sector absorbed **74.6%** of India's workforce. By 2011, this declined to **54.6%** (Cultivators 24.6% + Agricultural Labourers 30.0%). Conversely, the proportion of "Other Workers" (secondary and tertiary sectors) surged from 25.4% to **41.6%**, reflecting industrial diversification and economic modernization.
- **Spatial Variations in Work Participation:**
  - **High Participation States:** Tribal and mountainous states exhibit significantly higher work participation rates: **Himachal Pradesh (51.9%)**, **Nagaland (49.2%)**, **Sikkim (50.5%)**, and **Chhattisgarh (47.7%)**. In these subsistence agrarian and hill economies, widespread female participation in manual terrace farming and livestock grazing inflates the overall work rate.
  - **Low Participation States:** Densely populated Gangetic plain states record lower participation rates: **Uttar Pradesh (32.9%)**, **Bihar (33.4%)**, and **Punjab (35.7%)**, driven by low female work participation and high educational enrollment.
- **Gender Disparity:** Male work participation stands at **53.3%**, whereas female work participation is restricted to **25.5%**. A vast proportion of female labor in household chores, cooking, and unpaid family farm assistance remains unrecorded in formal census accounting.

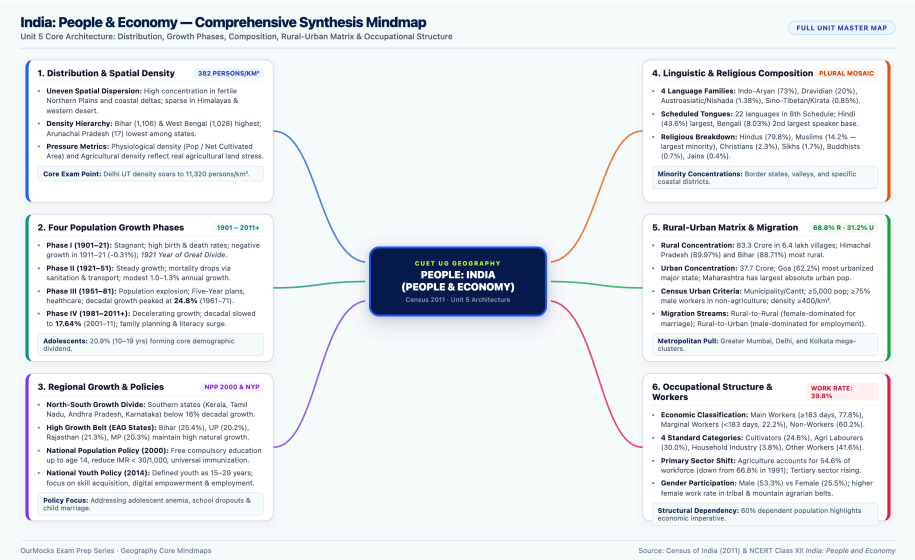


Figure 3: Complete Architectural Framework: People — India: People and Economy

6.3 Spatial Matrix of High-Yield Demographic Benchmarks

Core Demographic Benchmarks of Indian States (Census 2011)

Demographic Indicator	Leading State / Value	Lowest State / Benchmark Context
Highest / Lowest Population	Uttar Pradesh (19.98 Crore)	Sikkim (6.10 Lakh) · Lakshadweep UT (64,473)
Highest / Lowest Density	Bihar (1,106 persons/km^2)	Arunachal Pradesh (17 persons/km^2)
Highest Decadal Growth Rate	Meghalaya (27.95%) · Bihar (25.4%)	Nagaland (-0.58% — only negative growth state)
Lowest Decadal Growth Rate	Kerala (4.91% among major states)	Lakshadweep (6.30% among UTs)
Highest / Lowest Urbanization	Goa (62.17% urban)	Himachal Pradesh (10.03% urban · 89.97% rural)
Largest Language Family	Indo-Aryan Family (73.0%)	Sino-Tibetan Family (0.85%)

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Module 7: CUET High-Yield Practice Questions

Q1. According to the 2011 Census of India, which state recorded the highest arithmetic population density among all Indian states?

(A) West Bengal **(B)** Bihar
(C) Uttar Pradesh **(D)** Kerala

Sol. Q1. Bihar recorded the highest population density among all Indian states at 1,106 persons/km², followed by West Bengal at 1,028 persons/km².

Answer: (B)

Q2. Which year in Indian demographic history is universally designated as the "Year of the Great Divide"?

(A) 1901 **(B)** 1921
(C) 1951 **(D)** 1981

Sol. Q2. 1921 is known as the "Year of the Great Divide" because mortality declined steadily thereafter, ending the epoch of stagnant population growth.

Answer: (B)

Q3. Which Indian state recorded a negative decadal population growth rate during the 2001–2011 census decade?

(A) Kerala **(B)** Nagaland
(C) Sikkim **(D)** Goa

Sol. Q3. Nagaland was the only state to record a negative decadal population growth rate (-0.58%) during the 2001–2011 census period.

Answer: (B)

Q4. Physiological density of population is calculated as the ratio between:

(A) Total Population and Total Geographical Area **(B)** Total Population and Net Cultivated (Sown) Area
(C) Total Agricultural Population and Net Sown Area **(D)** Urban Population and Total Urban Area

Sol. Q4. Physiological density is defined as the total population divided by the net cultivated area, assessing actual dietary pressure on farmland.

Answer: (B)

Q5. According to Census 2011, what is the proportion of rural population in India?

(A) 72.2% **(B)** 68.8%
(C) 62.5% **(D)** 54.6%

Sol. Q5. According to the 2011 Census, 68.8% of India's population (83.3 crore) lives in rural areas, while 31.2% (37.7 crore) lives in urban areas.

Answer: (B)

Q6. Which is the smallest language family spoken in India in terms of percentage of speakers?

(A) Dravidian Family
(B) Sino-Tibetan (Kirata) Family
(C) Austroasiatic (Nishada) Family
(D) Indo-European (Aryan) Family

Sol. Q6. The Sino-Tibetan (Kirata) language family is the smallest in India, accounting for only 0.85% of total speakers, mainly in the Himalayan/NE belt.

Answer: (B)

Q7. According to Census 2011, which state has the highest percentage of urban population among all major Indian states?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Goa
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Punjab

Sol. Q7. Goa has the highest proportion of urban population (62.17%) among all Indian states, followed by Mizoram (52.11%) and Tamil Nadu (48.40%).

Answer: (B)

Q8. In the Census of India, a person who works in an economically productive activity for at least 183 days (six months) in a year is classified as a:

(A) Marginal Worker
(B) Main Worker
(C) Non-Worker
(D) Secondary Labourer

Sol. Q8. A Main Worker is defined by the Census as an individual who works for at least 183 days (or six months) in the preceding year.

Answer: (B)

Q9. Which internal migration stream in India is overwhelmingly dominated by female migrants?

(A) Rural-to-Urban
(B) Rural-to-Rural
(C) Urban-to-Urban
(D) Urban-to-Rural

Sol. Q9. Rural-to-Rural migration is heavily dominated by females due to the socio-cultural custom of marriage migration across villages.

Answer: (B)

Q10. What was the overall arithmetic population density of India as per the 2011 Census?

(A) 325 persons/km^2
(B) 382 persons/km^2
(C) 415 persons/km^2
(D) 450 persons/km^2

Sol. Q10. India's overall population density increased from 325 persons/km^2 in 2001 to 382 persons/km^2 in the 2011 Census.

Answer: (B)

Q11. Which of the following is NOT a mandatory criterion used by the Census of India to classify an area as a "Census Town"?

(A) A minimum population of 5,000 persons
(B) Having a Municipal Corporation established by state legislation
(C) At least 75% of male main working population engaged in non-agricultural pursuits
(D) A population density of at least 400 persons per square kilometer

Sol. Q11. Having a Municipal Corporation defines a "Statutory Town", not a "Census Town" (which is defined by population, occupation, and density).

Answer: (B)

Q12. According to the 2011 Census, which religious community has the highest concentration in the state of Punjab?

(A) Hindus
(B) Sikhs
(C) Muslims
(D) Christians

Sol. Q12. Sikhs constitute the majoritarian community in the state of Punjab, accounting for 57.7% of the state's total population in Census 2011.

Answer: (B)

Q13. The National Youth Policy (NYP) 2014 launched by the Government of India defines "Youth" as individuals belonging to the age group of:

(A) 10 to 19 years
(B) 15 to 29 years
(C) 18 to 35 years
(D) 15 to 24 years

Sol. Q13. The National Youth Policy 2014 defines youth as persons in the age bracket of 15 to 29 years, focusing on education, health, and skill development.

Answer: (B)

Q14. Which language family includes Santhali, Mundari, and the Khasi language spoken in Meghalaya?

(A) Dravidian Family
(B) Austroasiatic (Nishada) Family
(C) Sino-Tibetan Family
(D) Indo-European Family

Sol. Q14. Santhali, Mundari, Ho, and Khasi belong to the Austroasiatic (Nishada) language family, spoken by 1.38% of India's population.

Answer: (B)

Q15. In the 2011 Census, what percentage of the total workforce in India was engaged in the agricultural sector (cultivators + agricultural labourers)?

(A) 66.8%
(B) 54.6%
(C) 41.6%
(D) 38.2%

Sol. Q15. Agricultural workers (Cultivators 24.6% + Agricultural Labourers 30.0%) accounted for 54.6% of India's total workforce in 2011.

Answer: (B)